Practice workbook · Piaget's stages of cognitive development

Piaget's four stages, schemas, conservation, object permanence and evaluation of the theory.

10 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 9 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-DEV-01

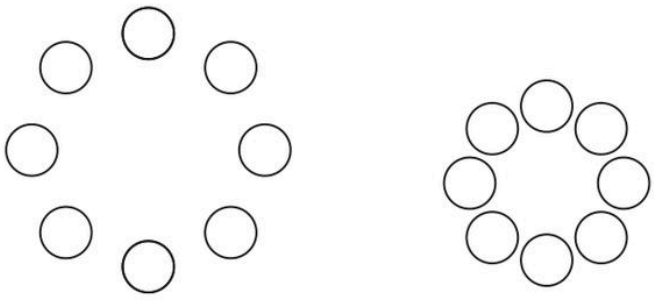
1. Question 4 · part b · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

4 Gastón wanted to investigate what stage of development children from a local community group were in.

He showed them two circles of marbles. Both circles had the same number of marbles, but Gastón spaced out the marbles more in Circle A (see **Figure 2**). He then asked the children which circle had the most marbles.



Circle A **Circle B**

Figure 2

(a) Explain what someone is likely to say about which circle had the most marbles if they are in the pre-operational stage of development.

You should refer to the pre-operational stage of development in your answer.

(2)

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1. Question 4 · part b · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Later, the children were given a picture of a 14-year-old person and were told they lived with their parents, ate a lot of healthy food and worked hard at school. They were then asked what this person might be like in 20 years' time.

Explain what someone is likely to say if they are in the formal operational stage of development.

You should refer to the formal operational stage of development in your answer.

(2)

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(Total for Question 4 = 4 marks)

Working and answer

2. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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2. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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4 Janet is a psychologist investigating cognitive development. She visits a local primary school and uses a task to assess the stages of cognitive development of the pupils at the school.

Firstly, sweets were arranged in Line A.

- Line A: Ten sweets in a row with 1cm between each of them.

Then, later the sweets were arranged in Line B.

- Line B: The same 10 sweets in a row but with 2cm between each of them.

Danielle says there are 10 sweets in line A, but she says there are 20 sweets in line B.

(a) Explain what stage of cognitive development Danielle is in according to her response.

You should refer to a theory in your answer.

(2)

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2. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Janet collects data on how children at Danielle's school perform in the task. She splits the children by age (in years), from 5 to 11 years old, with 50 children in each age group.

Their performance is shown in **Figure 1**.

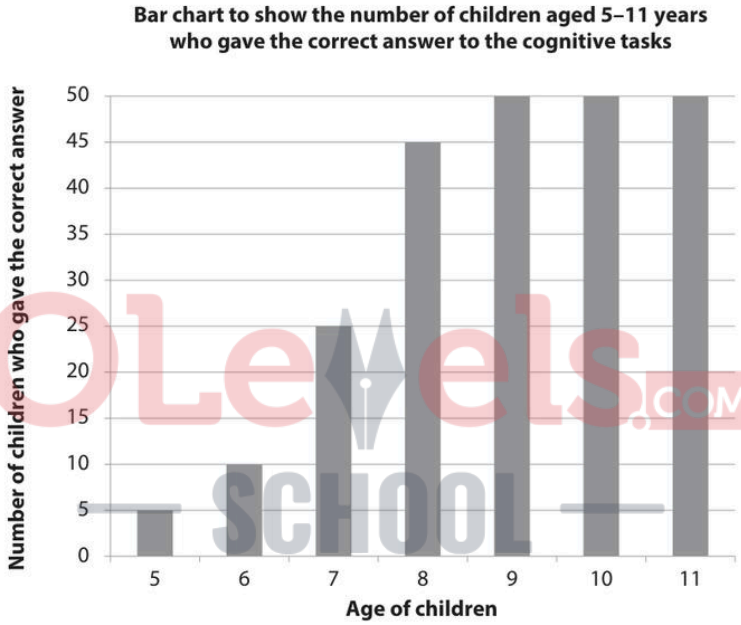


Figure 1

Explain **two** conclusions you could make from **Figure 1** about the cognitive development of the children at Danielle's school.

(4)

Conclusion one:

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P 5 9 6 6 8 A 0 6 3 6

2. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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3. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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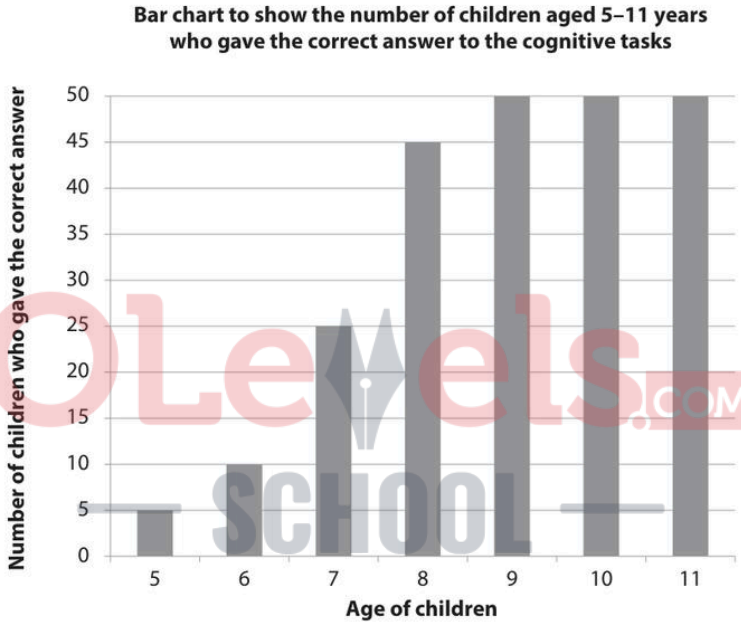


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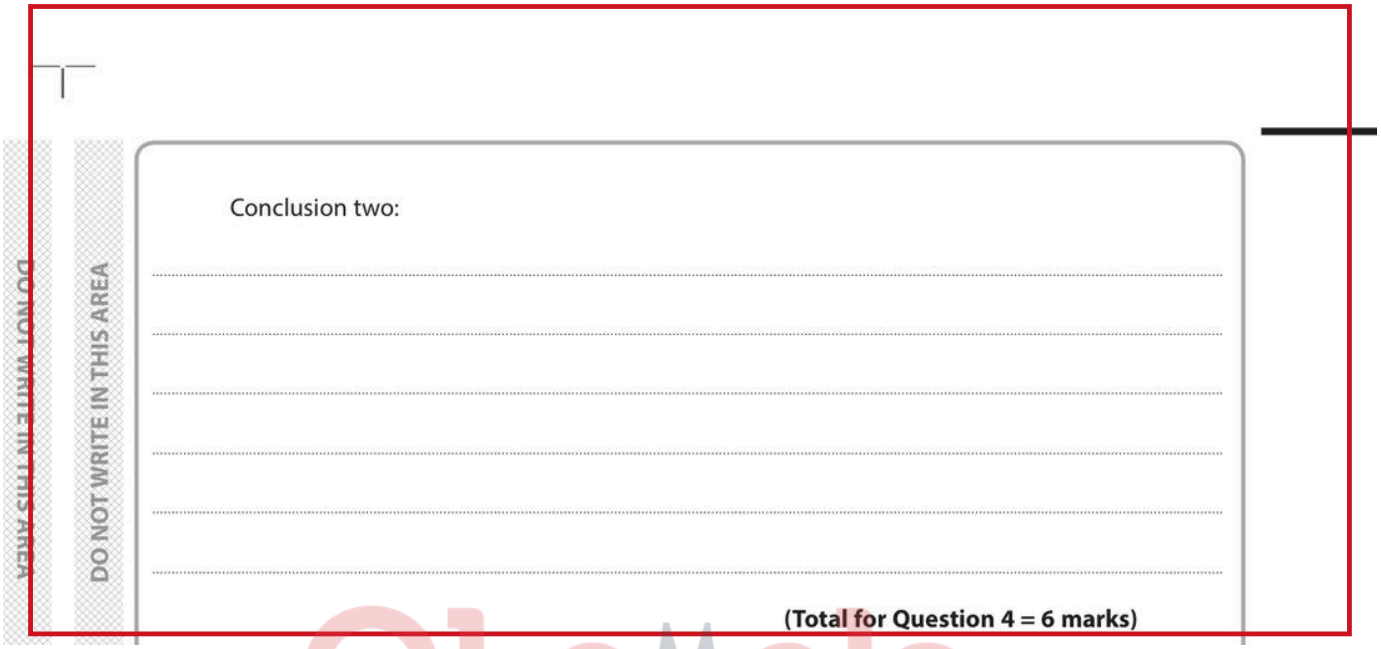
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3. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.



Working and answer

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4. Question 5 · part a · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part a only.

5 Beth is investigating the level of cognitive development of eight-month-old infants.

She is playing with her eight-month-old daughter in her living room at home.

Beth shows her daughter a ball and she reaches for it. Beth hides the ball behind a cushion. Her daughter reaches behind the cushion to get the ball back.

(a) Explain what this shows regarding Beth's daughter's cognitive development.

You should refer to Piaget's Theory of Cognitive Development in your answer.

(2)

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4. Question 5 · part a · 2 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of Beth's investigation into the level of cognitive development of eight-month-old infants.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 5 = 6 marks)

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4. Question 5 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

4 Georgia is four months old and from England. Her father is playing with her one day with her favourite toy duck, Mrs Duckie. Georgia's father is 'quacking' and she is laughing. She reaches for the toy duck but her father hides the toy duck behind the sofa. Georgia sits still and begins to cry.

(a) Explain what Georgia's reaction to her father hiding the toy duck shows regarding her cognitive development.

You should refer to Piaget's Theory of Cognitive Development in your answer.

(2)

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5. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Piaget's Theory of Cognitive Development to account for Georgia's behaviour after her father hides the toy duck.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 4 = 6 marks)

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5. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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6. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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6. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Piaget's Theory of Cognitive Development to account for Georgia's behaviour after her father hides the toy duck.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 4 = 6 marks)

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6. Question 4 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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7. Question 1 · part a · 1 mark

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Further practice · Attempt part a only.

1 Define what is meant by the following stages of Piaget's Theory of Cognitive Development.

(a) Sensorimotor stage

(1)

(b) Concrete operational stage

(1)

(Total for Question 1 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

8. Question 1 · part b · 1 mark

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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(a) Sensorimotor stage

(1)

(b) Concrete operational stage

(1)

(Total for Question 1 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

9. Question 3 · part whole · 2 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

3 Shannon is 3 years old and is in the park with her mum. She sees a bird flying over them. Her mum says, 'bird' and Shannon repeats this.

The next day, Shannon is in the park with her dad and sees an aeroplane in the sky. She points at the aeroplane and says, 'bird?' to her dad. Her dad smiles and says, 'No, that is an aeroplane.'

Explain why Shannon mistakenly thought the aeroplane was a bird.

You should refer to Piaget's Theory of Cognitive Development in your answer.

(2)

(Total for Question 3 = 2 marks)

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Working and answer

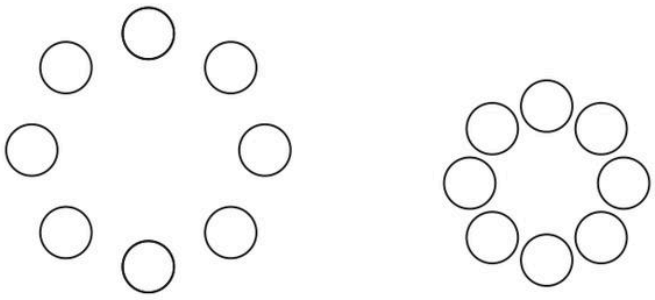
10. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

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He showed them two circles of marbles. Both circles had the same number of marbles, but Gastón spaced out the marbles more in Circle A (see **Figure 2**). He then asked the children which circle had the most marbles.



Circle A **Circle B**

Figure 2

(a) Explain what someone is likely to say about which circle had the most marbles if they are in the pre-operational stage of development.

You should refer to the pre-operational stage of development in your answer.

(2)

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10. Question 4 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

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(b) Later, the children were given a picture of a 14-year-old person and were told they lived with their parents, ate a lot of healthy food and worked hard at school. They were then asked what this person might be like in 20 years' time.

Explain what someone is likely to say if they are in the formal operational stage of development.

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Working and answer